

You are often the hardest person you will ever have to learn to love.

Isn't that strange? We can show compassion to strangers, forgive the people who hurt us, and remind others that their mistakes do not define them. Yet when we stand in front of the mirror, we become our own harshest critics. We replay every mistake, magnify every flaw, and convince ourselves that our accomplishments were nothing more than luck. We hold ourselves to standards we would never expect another person to meet.

But you deserve the same kindness you so freely give to everyone else.

You deserve to be proud of how far you've come. You deserve to acknowledge your

growth without feeling arrogant.
Appreciating yourself isn't vanity.
Recognizing your progress isn't selfish.
It's necessary.

Because at the end of the day, the longest relationship you will ever have is the one you have with yourself.

So start speaking to yourself with the same patience and understanding you would give to a friend. Celebrate your victories, even the ones that seem small. Forgive yourself for the things you cannot change. Stop punishing yourself for who you were when you were simply trying to survive, learn, and grow with what you knew at the time.

Embrace who you are today, while making room for the person you are becoming.

Loving yourself isn't a destination you eventually arrive at. It's a choice you make every day. Some days, that choice will feel easy. Other days, it will feel almost impossible. But both days matter.

Have patience with yourself. Growth takes time, and healing is rarely a straight line. You are allowed to be a work in progress. You are allowed to have bad days. You are allowed to fall apart, take a step back, and begin again.

Some days will feel heavy, but they still count.

So celebrate the small victories. Give yourself grace. Keep going, even when you cannot see the progress yet.

Because you are becoming better, even on the days when you feel like you aren't.

And maybe learning to love yourself isn't about becoming someone you finally believe is worthy of love.

Maybe it's realizing that you were worthy all along.